InfiniTea

Hourglass Tea Brewing System

Design Process

EMPHATIZE

TEA RITUALS & BREWING PRACTICES RESEARCH

DEFINE

PROBLEM: TEA PREPARATION LOSING RITUAL VALUE

IDEATE

GRAVITY-BASED BREWING CONCEPTS

PROTOTYPE

HOURGLASS ROTATING SYSTEM

TEST

VISUALIZATIONS AND USER SCENARIO

FINAL DIRECTION

INFINITEA

InfiniTea

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Emphatize

MILESTONE: UNDERSTANDING TEA RITUALS

Key insight:
Tea preparation is traditionally a slow, sensory ritual, focused on calmness and presence.

Keywords:
ritual · patience · aroma · sensory brewing

Prompt
"Research tea rituals and brewing practices."

AI Role: 🟦 Clarifier

AI Response Summary
Provided information about tea rituals, brewing stages, and sensory aspects of tea culture.

Reflection:
The research showed that time and sensory experience are essential elements of tea brewing.

InfiniTea

Define

MILESTONE: LOSING RITUALS VALUE

Problem:
Modern tea machines prioritize automation and efficiency, often losing the ritual and sensory experience.

Opportunity:
Create a brewing system that combines precision with ritual interaction.

Prompt
“How can tea brewing become a ritual rather than just a function?”

AI Role: Re-framer

AI Summary:
Suggested shifting focus from automation to experience and ritual.

Reflection:
This reframed the project from machine design to ritual experience design.

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Ideation

MILESTONE: EXPLORING UNCONVENTIONAL BREWING MECHANISMS

Explored ideas:
- rotating hourglass brewer
- gravity-based infusion
- steam activation of herbs

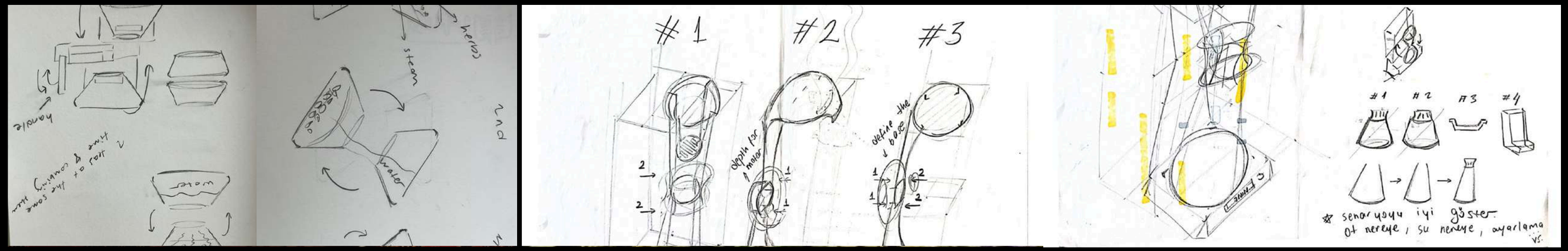
Goal:
Translate tea brewing stages into physical movement and form.

Prompt
"Explore unusual brewing mechanisms for tea."

AI Role: Expander

AI Summary:
Suggested concepts like rotating systems and gravity-based brewing.

Reflection:
Gravity became a central concept for controlling brewing stages.



Prototype

MILESTONE: GRAVITY-DRIVEN BREWING SYSTEM

Concept:

Water → Herbs → Tea

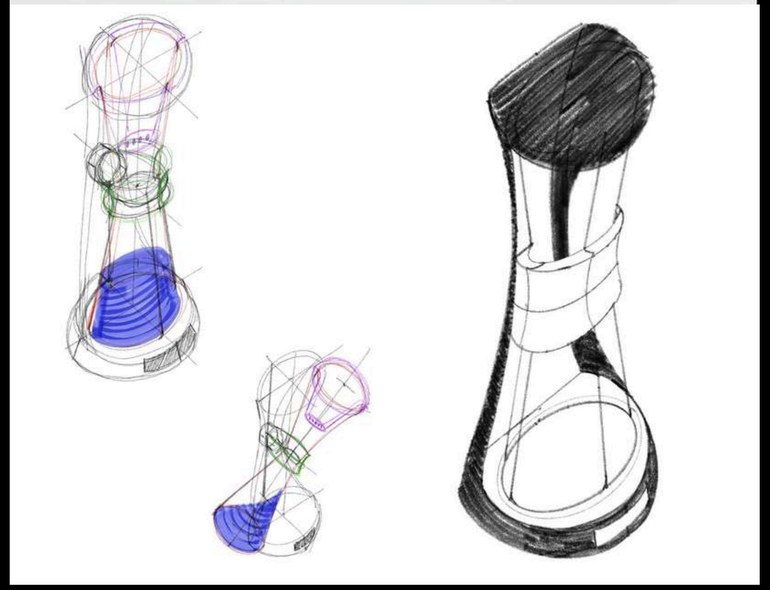
The hourglass rotation allows water to flow through herbs naturally.

Prompt
"Evaluate the rotating hourglass tea brewing concept."

AI Role: 🟥 Critique

AI Summary:
Highlighted benefits such as ritual movement and visual brewing process.

Reflection:
Confirmed that the concept creates both functional and experiential value.



Test

MILESTONE:
EVALUATING THE BREWING MECHANISM AND USER INTERACTION

Prompt
"Evaluate the rotating hourglass tea brewing concept."

AI Role: Critique

AI Response Summary
The rotating hourglass concept strengthens the ritual aspect of tea preparation and clearly communicates the brewing stages through visible movement.

Reflection
The visual transformation of water and herbs creates a strong experiential narrative for the product.

Design Decision
Maintain the hourglass rotation mechanism and emphasize transparency so users can observe the brewing process.

Final Direction

Key Design Decisions:

- Use gravity to control brewing flow
- Hourglass form representing time
- Minimal interface with digital timer
- Transparent glass to reveal transformation

These decisions align with the concept of time and ritual.

Direction Map:

Accepted:
- gravity-driven brewing
- hourglass rotation system
- ritual-focused experience

Rejected:
- fully automated tea machines
- app-based controls
- complex brewing interfaces

Transformed:
- traditional tea ritual → mechanical brewing ritual

AI Collaboration Overview and Reflection

Examples of impactful prompts:

Research tea rituals, Clarifier
Reframe tea brewing problem, Re-framer
Explore gravity mechanisms, Expander
Evaluate concept, Critique

AI helped:
- clarify research
- expand idea exploration
- critique concept feasibility

Reflection:

The development of InfiniTea started with researching tea rituals and brewing practices. This research highlighted the importance of time, observation, and calm interaction in traditional tea preparation. As a result, the project shifted from designing a functional appliance to creating a ritual-centered brewing experience. The final concept uses gravity, flow, and an hourglass form to guide the brewing process while visually expressing the transformation of water and herbs into tea. AI supported the process by helping clarify research, expand ideas, and evaluate concepts.